Ronith Sharmila
Southwestern Oklahoma State University, Weatherford, Oklahoma, USA
ronith.sharmila@swosu.edu
October 17, 2026

Editor
Machine Learning
Springer

Dear Editor,

We are submitting our paper "Do Language Models Write Away Their Own Oversight? A Preregistered Test of Constitutional Self-Revision" as a research article in *Machine Learning*.

Language models are increasingly used to critique and revise their own governing principles, ranging from constitutional training to self-refining agents. A long-standing argument in AI safety suggests that such reflection should slowly eliminate commitments to human oversight. We directly test this prediction and find that it fails in our setting: oversight commitments were not selectively eroded; erosion concentrated instead in stylistic self-restraints.

We consider the manuscript appropriate for *Machine Learning* for the following reasons: (1) it offers an empirical procedure to assess value drift in iterated self-revision by matching categories of items, including controls, and using discrete-time survival analysis; (2) it reports a preregistered null result, along with a transparent discussion of the limitations of the data; and (3) it provides the entire dataset, the frozen analysis code and the decision log to allow all results to be verified and further developed.

This article has not been published and is not under consideration for publication elsewhere. All authors have approved the article and its submission to this journal. The research was preregistered on OSF: `https://osf.io/mw86p`. No previously published figures, tables or text are reused. Enclosed is the *Machine Learning* Contribution Information Sheet.

Thank you for considering our work.

Sincerely,

Ronith Sharmila (corresponding author)
Southwestern Oklahoma State University, Weatherford, Oklahoma, USA
ronith.sharmila@swosu.edu
On behalf of co-author Rupesh Agrawal (Northern Kentucky University)